myself at first, until the tempo gradual y built up. Based on my preliminary studies on ground-handling equipment, a project team was formed to design and develop an indigenous hovercraft prototype as a ground equipment machine (GEM). The team was a smal working group, comprising four persons at the level of Scientific Assistant. Dr OP Mediratta, Director of the ADE, asked me to lead the team. We were given three years to launch the engineering model.

The project was, by any standards, bigger than our col ective capabilities. None of us had any experience in building a machine, let alone a flying machine. There were no designs or standard components available to begin with. Al we knew was that we had to make a successful heavier-than-air flying machine. We tried to read as much literature as we could find on hovercrafts, but there was not much available. We tried to consult people knowledgeable in this area, but could find none. One day, I simply took the decision to proceed with the limited information and resources available.

This endeavour to produce a wingless, light, swift machine opened the windows of my mind. I was quick to